

Q: What is a project? How is it different from other work?

A: A project is a temporary endeavor to create a unique product, service, or result. Unlike ongoing operations, it has a defined start and end.

Q: How is a project different from a program or a portfolio?

A: A project is a single initiative; a program is a group of related projects; a portfolio is a collection of projects/programs aligned with strategic goals.

Q: What are the five stages in a project life cycle? Briefly describe what happens in each.

A: 1. Initiating: Define project and get approval. 2. Planning: Set scope, schedule, and budget. 3. Executing: Perform the work. 4. Monitoring & Controlling: Track progress. 5. Closing: Finalize and close project.

Q: Why is it important to align projects with business strategy?

A: It ensures that resources are used efficiently and the project contributes to organizational goals.

Q: List and briefly describe the four types of organizational structures. What are the strengths and weaknesses of each from a project perspective?

A: 1. Functional: Departments; weak PM authority. 2. Matrix: Shared authority; better resource use. 3. Projectized: Full PM authority; flexible. 4. Composite: Mix of structures.

Q: What are the roles and responsibilities of a project manager?

A: Lead the team, manage scope, time, cost, quality, risk, and communication to deliver project objectives.

Q: What are the characteristics of effective project managers?

A: Strong leadership, communication, problem-solving, negotiation, and team-building skills.

Q: List and describe the three levels of project management maturity. How does maturity affect project success?

A: 1. Low: Ad hoc processes. 2. Medium: Standardized methods. 3. High: Optimized, continuous improvement. Higher maturity increases success likelihood.

Q: What are some common reasons why projects fail?

A: Unclear goals, poor planning, inadequate resources, weak leadership, scope creep, and lack of stakeholder engagement.

Q: What are some benefits of using formal project management practices?

A: Improved efficiency, better risk management, clearer communication, and higher success rates.

Q: Explain the key differences between predictive (plan-driven) and adaptive (Agile) project management approaches.

A: Predictive uses detailed upfront planning; Agile adapts to changes with iterative cycles and frequent feedback.

Q: Why is stakeholder engagement critical in project management?

A: Stakeholders influence project success; their involvement ensures needs are met and reduces resistance.

Q: How do the principles in the PMBOK® Guide (7th Edition) differ from previous editions?

A: It emphasizes principles and performance domains over process groups and knowledge areas.

Q: Why is it important to define success criteria for a project? Who should be involved in defining it?

A: To measure project outcomes effectively. Project manager, sponsor, and stakeholders should define it.

Q: Why are interpersonal skills critical for project managers? Name at least four and explain their importance.

A: They build trust, resolve conflicts, and motivate teams. Key skills: communication, leadership, negotiation, and emotional intelligence.

Q: What are the major knowledge areas in project management as defined in earlier editions

of the PMBOK® Guide?

A: Integration, Scope, Time, Cost, Quality, HR, Communications, Risk, Procurement, and Stakeholder Management.

Q: How do cultural differences impact project management? Provide examples.

A: They affect communication, decision-making, and leadership. E.g., attitudes toward hierarchy and time can vary globally.

Q: How does the role of a project sponsor differ from the project manager? Why is this relationship important?

A: Sponsor provides support, funding, and high-level decisions. The PM manages day-to-day tasks. Collaboration ensures alignment.

Q: What are some ethical issues that can arise in project management? How should a project manager handle them?

A: Conflict of interest, dishonesty, favoritism. PMs should follow codes of ethics and report concerns.

Q: What do you hope to gain from studying project management?

A: Knowledge to manage projects efficiently, improve team coordination, and deliver successful outcomes.